

Visby — Design System

The canonical visual spec for Visby. If a screen feels off, it's almost always breaking one of these rules. Everything here is enforced through helpers in `src/lib/ui.ts` and tokens in `src/styles/tokens.css` — **use the helpers; don't hand-roll inline numbers.**

1. North star

A **calm, premium marketplace** — the discipline of Google/Instagram (generous whitespace, one clear hierarchy, ruthless consistency) wearing Visby's identity: *Ambient Glass Futurism* — frosted glass floating over a greyscale aurora, with colour entering **only** through the brand gradient.

Three principles decide most arguments:

- 1. **One focal point per surface.** A card sells one thing: the image. A section has one job.
- 2. **Whitespace over borders.** Separate things with space, not lines.
- 3. **Restraint.** ≤ 3 type sizes per screen, gradient on ≤ 2 elements per screen, greyscale everywhere else.

2. Brand invariants (never change without a deliberate decision)

- The **Visby wordmark/logo** is frozen. Never restyle it.
- Background is the global greyscale **aurora** (`<BackgroundField/>`); dark mode adds a near imperceptible white bloom. Glass never glows. Page roots stay transparent.
- Colour comes **only** from `--grad-brand` (`135deg #25CDB8 → #2A8AED → #BC2DE6`). Functional red `#FF3B5C` and green `#00C48C` appear **only** on real error/success states.
- No emojis anywhere — inline SVG icons only.

3. Type scale — `t(role)`

Six roles. Every text node uses one (`price()` / `sectionLabel()`). Nothing else.

role	size	weight	font	use
display	30	800	Quicksand	rare hero numbers/moments
title	22	700	Quicksand	page titles
heading	16	700	Manrope	card titles, section titles
body	14	500	Manrope	default text
meta	12	500	Manrope	secondary / metadata

micro	11	700	Manrope	uppercase eyebrow labels (0.06em tracking)
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```
<div style={{ ...t('heading'), color: 'var(--text-strong)' }}>Air Jordan 1</div>
<span style={{ ...t('meta'), color: 'var(--text-muted)' }}>2 owners</span>
```

Quicksand is reserved for the wordmark, title, and display. Everything else is Manrope.

Never write a raw `fontSize`/`fontWeight` outside this scale — the one exception is price.

4. Spacing — s (4/8 grid)

S = {1:4, 2:8, 3:12, 4:16, 5:24, 6:32, 7:48, 8:64}. Every padding / margin / gap comes from

s. Mirrored in CSS as `--s-1 ... --s-8` for stylesheet use.

context	value
card internal padding	S[4] (16)
gap within a card	S[2]–S[3] (8–12)
gap between section blocks	S[6] (32)
grid gap	16 (<code>--s-4</code>), 24 at ≥ 1440 px
list-item padding	12px 16px
button padding	12px 20px
input padding	13px 16px

If a value isn't on the grid, it's wrong.

5. Radius

Tightened for an editorial feel. Set once in `tokens.css`; consume via the `var(--r*)` tokens.

token	px	use
<code>--r-sm</code>	12	inputs, badges, icon boxes, nested surfaces
<code>--r</code>	16	rectangular buttons
<code>--r-lg</code>	20	content cards
<code>--r-xl</code>	28	modals, bottom sheets
<code>--pill</code>	999	CTAs, chips, tab slider, avatars

6. Colour & gradient usage

- **Surfaces & text:** greyscale tokens only (`--text*`, `--glass-*`, `--surface-bg`). Never hardcode `#fff`/`#000`/theme hexes — they won't flip with light/dark.

- **Brand gradient** is allowed on, and only on: the **primary CTA**, **price** text, the **active** tab/nav item, **avatars**, **story rings**, and the occasional gradient heading.

- That's the whole colour budget. If a third thing on screen is coloured, remove it.

7. Glass — the nesting law

Glass is the brand, but stacked glass turns to mud. The law:

Never put glass inside glass.

- **Real frosted glass** (`card()`, `glass()`, `sheet()`, the sticky nav) is for *top-level* surfaces only: the nav, a modal/bottom sheet, the one elevated card in a group.
- Anything **nested inside** a glass surface — icon boxes, stat tiles, list rows, filter rows, grouped settings — uses `surface()`: a near-solid fill with a hairline border and **no blur**. It reads as a quiet inset panel without compounding the frost.
- The soft inner-highlight (`-glass-inner`) belongs to top-level cards, not to little nested chips.
- Badges sitting on photos use `badge('onImage')`, which carries its own `--img-scrim`.

8. Component anatomy (all in `src/lib/ui.ts`)

helper	what it is
<code>card(o?)</code>	elevated frosted card (top-level panels)
<code>sheet(o?)</code>	frosted glass for modals / bottom sheets
<code>surface(o?)</code>	near-solid nested panel, no blur — {radius?, pad?, bordered?}
<code>btn(variant, o?)</code>	primary(<code>gradient</code>) / secondary(<code>glass</code>) / text(<code>bare</code>) / danger(<code>red</code>); {full?, pill?}
<code>badge(variant)</code>	default / onImage / success / danger
<code>price(size)</code>	gradient price text — sm16 / md22 / lg30
<code>avatar(size)</code>	circle — sm32 / md48 / lg64 (fill with a brand gradient)
<code>tabSlider()</code>	the segmented control ({wrap, item, itemActive})
<code>sectionLabel()</code>	uppercase eyebrow label
<code>input()</code>	form input surface
<code>t(role), S, T</code>	type scale / spacing / colour tokens

Buttons: exactly four variants — don't invent a fifth. Primary = the one main action per view. `{full:true}` for full-width (also guarantees the gradient never clips).

Listing card (`src/components/listing-card.tsx`) is the reference card: square image hero, one `onImage` badge, an Instagram-style like affordance, then heading name → seller meta → `price('md')`. The whole card is a single tap target. Item grids reuse this structure.

Tabs: profile, dashboard, and sell all use `tabSlider()` — never a bespoke segmented control.

9. Do / Don't

Don't	Do			
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fontSize: 13 (off-scale)	...t('meta')			
padding: '11px 13px'	padding: S[3] / '12px 16px'			
glass card inside a glass card	card() → surface() inside			
5 different button styles	`btn('primary' \	'secondary' \	'text' \	'danger')`
dark rgba(0,0,0,.55) + blur + border on a photo badge, hand-written	badge('onImage')			
"NFT verified · Solana devnet · MPC wallet"	show only what a buyer/seller needs			
three accent colours on one screen	gradient on CTA + price, greyscale rest			
sections divided by boxed borders	S[6] of whitespace, optional hairline --divider			

10. Cleanliness checklist (Google/Instagram bar)

Before shipping a screen:

- ≤ 3 type sizes visible; all from `t()`.
- Every gap/padding is on the `S` grid.
- Gradient appears on ≤ 2 elements (CTA, price).
- No glass inside glass; nested panels are `surface()`.
- One clear focal point; secondary info is muted `meta`.
- Generous breathing room; nothing crammed against an edge.
- No jargon/noise text a normal buyer wouldn't need.
- Reads cleanly in **both** light and dark.

11. Product experience principles (UX law — same weight as the visual rules)

Visby's user might be holding crypto for the first time in their life. Design for them.

1. **Toddler-proof rule.** If a flow needs explaining, it's wrong. One primary action per screen; the next step should be the obvious big button.

2. **Plain English, zero crypto jargon.** User-facing copy says **"Tally"**, never "NFT"; "your wallet", never "MPC/embedded wallet"; "verified history", never "on-chain provenance". Jargon is allowed only on merchant/SDK developer pages.

3. **Progressive disclosure.** Advanced things (wallet addresses, tx hashes, chain details) live behind a tap, never up front. Default views show only what a buyer/seller needs.

4. **Always show the final cost before confirming.** Fees, shipping, conversion — the number

the user approves is the number that moves. No surprises, ever. Sellers see the 9% + shipping math before they list.

5. **Every state helps.** Empty states say what to do next; errors say what happened and how to fix it in one sentence; loading states never strand the user.

6. **Calm, premium, never cyberpunk.** Trust is the product. The interface stays quiet so the goods (and their verified history) are the show.

7. **Fail safely and honestly.** If a payment/mint step fails, the user sees the truth and a retry — never a stuck "did it work?" screen. (Order state machine backs this.)

8. **Admin surfaces** follow the same system with the "white + shadows" read: `surface()` density, no glass stacking, data-first.

12. File map

- `src/lib/ui.ts` — helpers + scale (t, S, price, card, sheet, surface, btn, badge, avatar, tabSlider, sectionLabel, input, T).

- `src/styles/tokens.css` — CSS variables: colour, glass, `--surface-bg`, `--img-scrim`, type sizes (`--fs-*`), spacing (`--s-*`), radii (`--r*`), gradients, motion.

- `src/app/globals.css` — resets, fonts, keyframes, `.visby-page / .visby-inner / .visby-grid` responsive containers.

- `src/components/listing-card.tsx` — the reference card.

- `src/components/background-field.tsx` — the global aurora.